Prayers for our World and the Church
1st November 2026

Psalms 116:16-17

"O Lord, surely I am Your servant, I am Your servant, the son of Your handmaid, You have loosed my bonds. To You I shall offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving, And call upon the name of the Lord."

Let us pray…

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that You have "loosed our bonds" and released us from our enslavement to sin. Now we are free to offer our sacrifice of thanksgiving, through the sacrifice of Jesus on the Cross, which we remember and celebrate today.

We thank You for giving us the faith to be saved, for we could not bridge the gap which separated us from You by ourselves.

We thank You for the Resurrection, and the righteousness we have received in Jesus, the spotless lamb who was slain.

We thank You for the sanctifying work of the Holy Spirit, Who is with us daily to enable us to resist temptation and grow to be more like Jesus, until we are fully mature in our faith, with wisdom to discern how to live in this fallen world.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We thank You for the Church, the pillar and guardian of the Truth, for those who have fought the good fight in the past, firstly the apostles, then saints and martyrs down through the ages. We thank You that we can mark today as Reformation Sunday, and recall the restoration of Scripture to its rightful place as a means of grace and our guide for daily living, so that we have received the blessing of Your written Word preserved for us by the work of many Reformers. We pray for this world which needs a similar "reformation" so that Your Word is again held in high honour, and where Truth is recognised and is again upheld instead of lies.

We pray for the many churches where Your Word is faithfully preached and lived, and ask that You would strengthen Your people to stand firm in the face of opposition. We pray for the Bible League work of bringing Your Word to believers suffering persecution, and thank You that we can support them financially in our October mission giving.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, as we also labour with our various talents and abilities in the work of the Kingdom.v

We continue to pray for the Selection Committee as they seek Your wisdom in the search for a new minister of Your choosing. We pray for ourselves to support them in their work on our behalf.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand – for Levi, for Joan, and for John, and any others affected by illness or injury. We also uphold Sophia and the child she carries, asking that You keep them to term, and that we may all rejoice in a new life safely delivered in due time.

We thank You for Your Word, read and preached today. We thank You for Douglas as he opens it up to us today. We have been so blessed by his faithful and effective leadership among us, and pray that You continue to uphold him and Joan, as we await the deliberations of Presbytery in their review of our circumstances.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.

As we will shortly take part in the Lord's Supper, let is recall the fundamentals of our faith, delivered once for all to the saints, handed down and preserved through the ages, by reciting The Apostle's Creed:

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit
and born of the virgin Mary.
He suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died, and was buried;
he descended to hell.
The third day he rose again from the dead.
He ascended to heaven
and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty.
From there he will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic* church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and the life everlasting. Amen.